Director of Software Delivery

Summary

Leads end-to-end delivery across a multi-team software organization of 200+ engineers. Accountable for turning strategic priorities into reliable, predictable releases while unifying delivery practices across teams with different histories, tooling, and cadences.

Key Responsibilities

- Establish and run a unified delivery operating model (planning cadence, intake, prioritization, release management) across all product and platform teams.
- Own portfolio-level planning and dependency management, surfacing cross-team risks early and driving resolution.
- Define and report delivery metrics (DORA metrics, flow efficiency, predictability, escaped defects) and use them to drive improvement, not just status.
- Partner with the Technical Director on engineering standards, CI/CD, and platform investments that reduce delivery friction.
- Partner with product, UX, and requirements stakeholders to ensure work is well-defined and ready before it enters development.
- Lead a team of delivery managers, program managers, and release/scrum leads; coach them on servant leadership and outcome focus.
- Govern release readiness, change management, and production incident follow-through.
- Represent delivery status, capacity, and tradeoffs to executive leadership and customers with candor.

Qualifications

- 10+ years in software development or delivery, with 5+ years leading delivery across multiple concurrent teams.
- Demonstrated success scaling agile or lean practices (SAFe, LeSS, or custom hybrids) in organizations of 100+ engineers.

- Strong grasp of modern engineering practices: CI/CD, DevSecOps, trunk-based development, feature flagging.
- Experience leading through organizational mergers or restructuring, harmonizing process without flattening useful differences.
- Data-driven approach to delivery management and continuous improvement.
- Excellent executive communication and conflict-resolution skills.

Preferred

- Experience in regulated or mission environments (defense, intelligence, federal), including ATO and accreditation timelines.
- Background delivering AI/ML-enabled capabilities.
- Relevant certifications (PMP, SAFe SPC/RTE, PMI-ACP), valued but not required.

Success Looks Like (First Year)

- One consistent delivery cadence and intake process across all teams.
- Baseline and measurable improvement in lead time and release predictability.
- Leadership trusts delivery forecasts enough to plan against them.